

Fixing Submission Errors in the MJFF Grant Portal

Last verified by Christina Murphy on 08-29-2025

Please refer to this guide for further explanation on submission validation errors that might pop up when trying to submit your application. If you need further assistance correcting your application, or are experiencing issues submitting, please send an email to the grants team at grants@michaeljfox.org

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Pre-Proposal Submission Errors and Solutions

ERROR	REASON FOR ERROR	SOLUTION FOR ERROR
Please update your profile by clicking on the Go to Profile button below.	Profiles must be up-to-date in Active status in order to submit an application.	At the top of the application, click the “Go to Profile” button. There, you will see your profile is in Draft status. Please complete any blank fields on your profile and press “Submit” to re-activate your account. Once your profile is back in Active status, you will be able to submit your application.
Project Title cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please fill in this field with what you want the project title to be.

Project duration cannot be X months.	If your project duration does not meet the parameters for the funding opportunity you are applying for, the system will prevent you from submitting.	Please adjust the number of months of your project according to the requirements stated in the program's overview guidelines on the MJFF website.
Project Abstract cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the "Project Information & Description" tab. Please fill in this field with a summary of the goals for your project.
Please select at least three keywords that best describe your proposed work. cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the "Project Information & Description" tab. Please fill in this field with three keywords from the dropdown menu.
Will you be requesting Biosamples as part of your application? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the "Project Information & Description" tab. Please select yes or no for this field.

Please complete the Biosample Request Activity before submitting the application.	If you are requesting biosamples, this is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Click the “Open” button to access the form and complete the necessary field(s). Upon completion, click the “Submit” button, and close the activity. More information about completing this activity can be found in the biosample activity guidance here .
Is this proposal a resubmission of a previously submitted proposal? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select yes or no for this field.
Where did you hear about this opportunity? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select one checkbox in this field.
Is this your first application focusing on Parkinson’s disease research? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select yes or no for this field.

Is this your first application to The Michael J. Fox Foundation for Parkinson's Research? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select yes or no for this field.
Are any investigators on your team new to Parkinson's disease research? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select yes or no for this field.
Have you applied for institutional approval for the proposed work? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Information & Description” tab. Please select yes or no for this field.
Pre-Proposal Confirmation cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Proposal Template” tab. Please read and acknowledge the statement by checking the box.

Pre-Proposal Confirmation Signature cannot be empty. Please type the full name of the Principal Investigator for confirmation. This should be the main applicant and the same person listed in the Principal Investigator role in the Research Team Members grid.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the “Project Proposal Template” tab. Please confirm your submission of your application by typing in your full name.
Please make sure to use the project proposal template provided for this funding opportunity.	If you are using the incorrect project proposal template, the system will not permit you to submit your application.	To ensure you are using the correct template, download the file that’s located in the “Documents” field at the top of the application, under “Print Preview”. Submit your application using the corrected proposal template.

The Principal Investigator's career stage permitted for this funding opportunity should be in 'X', 'Y', 'Z' stage. Please ensure that the named Principal Investigator reflects the appropriate career stage.	Depending on the Funding Opportunity you are applying for, the Principal Investigator role must be at a certain career level. The system will prevent you from submitting if the career level for the Principal Investigator is not the appropriate one.	To update the career levels of your team, go to the "Team Information" tab, click the "Add Research Team Member Information" button, and in the new pop-up screen, complete the Career Stage field by selecting from the dropdown. Then click the "Save" button. To see your work reflected in the grid, click the "Save Draft" button on the application. This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.
Please ensure ORCID ID is entered in a valid format.	All members entered in the team grid must have an ORCID ID in order to submit your application.	If you or a team member does not currently have an ORCID, we ask that you create a free account here. To update the ORCID numbers for your team, go to the "Team Information" tab, click the "Add or Edit Research Team Member Information" button, and in the new pop-up screen, complete the ORCID field by entering the ID number. Then click the "Save" button. To see your work reflected in the grid, click the "Save Draft" button on the application. This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.

Career stage for each co-PI must be in 'X', 'Y', 'Z' stage.	Depending on the Funding Opportunity you are applying for, the Co-Principal Investigator role must be at a certain career level. The system will prevent you from submitting if the career level for the Co-Principal Investigator is not the appropriate one.	To update the career levels of your team, go to the "Team Information" tab, click the "Add Research Team Member Information" button, and in the new pop-up screen, complete the Career Stage field by selecting from the dropdown. Then click the "Save" button. To see your work reflected in the grid, click the "Save Draft" button on the application. This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.
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Full Proposal Submission Errors and Solutions

ERROR	REASON FOR ERROR	SOLUTION FOR ERROR
Please update your profile by clicking on the Go to Profile button below.	Profiles must be up-to-date and in active status in order to submit an application.	To update your profile, at the top of the application, click the "Go to Profile" button. There, you will see your profile is in Draft status. Please complete any blank fields on your profile and press the "Submit" button to re-activate your account. Once your profile is back in Active status, you will be able to submit your application.

Please add at least one person with the Co-Principal Investigator role for each collaborating institution in the Research Team Members grid.	Per MJFF's Team and Budget Guidelines, each institution added as a collaborating institution needs to have at least one Co-Principal Investigator. The system will prevent you from submitting if this requirement is not satisfied.	This can be updated by going to the "Team Information" tab, clicking on the "Add Research Team Member Information" button, and in the new pop-up screen, clicking the plus sign to add a new row, and filling in the research team fields. Then click the "Save" button to process this update. To see your work reflected in the grid, click the "Save Draft" button on the application.
Are you requesting additional funding for use of Non-Human Primates? cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This question can be found in the Project Information & Description field. Please use the dropdown to select Yes or No.
Please complete the Biosample Request Activity before submitting the application.	If you are requesting biosamples, this is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the "Project Information & Description" tab. Click the "Open" button to access the form and complete the necessary field(s). Upon completion, click the "Submit" button, and close the activity. More information about completing this activity can be found in the biosample activity guidance here.

Invalid numeric input of Total Requested Amount (in United States Dollars)	The number entered in the Total Requested Amount must match the Grand Total amount from your Budget Template, and both must be in USD, in order to submit your application.	This field can be found in the Project Information & Description tab. Please enter the correct amount that you are requesting in USD for this project. Please verify that the amount entered is the same as the Grand Total amount from your Budget Template. Please refer to the exchange rates section of MJFF's Team and Budget Guidelines , if needed.
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We want to learn more about your efforts to inclusively attract, support, and retain a diverse research team. Please describe the makeup of your team, how your team is diverse, and the steps taken /criteria used to put together the team, particularly as it pertains to the characteristics of diversity described above. If it is not diverse, please explain why not. Teams that demonstrate a coherent approach towards diversity and inclusion will be taken into consideration and incorporated in the application review. cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the Team Information tab. Please type in the text box further details about your team members.
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Your total number of accepted invitations with the role "XXXX" should match the number team members with the role "XXXX."	All Co-Principal Investigators, Paid Collaborators and Unpaid Collaborators that you've included in your research team members section must have been invited to collaborate on the application and have also accepted that invitation in order to submit your application.	To ensure that the Team Members section matches the invitations to collaborate sent, go to the Team Information tab. Here you can see under the Invitations section who you have invited and who has accepted the invitation. For further instructions on how to invite team members to collaborate, please refer to the Invitations to Collaborate section of the MJFF Proposal Instructions.
A biosketch is required for all team members.	Biosketches must be uploaded for all Co-Principal Investigators, Paid Collaborators, Unpaid Collaborators and Consultants in order to submit your application.	This field can be found in the Team Information tab under "Research Team Members." To upload a biosketch, click the upload button on the table in the respective row of the member you want. A new pop-up will appear. Click the file button to search for the file, and then click the Upload button. Upon seeing the confirmation banner, you can close that window and click the "Save Draft" button on your application to see the biosketch appear in the team grid.

Please make sure you use the current version of the MJFF budget template, available for download on the field.	If you are using the incorrect version of the MJFF budget template, the system will prevent you from submitting your application.	You can find this field in the Attachments tab. To ensure you are using the correct budget template, click the “Download Budget Template” button within the Budget Template field. Once you have used the correct template, the system will permit you to submit your application.
Please make sure you upload institution approval letters for each collaborating institution.	These letters must be completed and submitted by all organizations in order to submit your application.	This field can be completed in the Attachments tab under the Collaborating Institution Attachments section. For each organization you need to upload a letter for, click the “Upload Documents” button, and in the new pop-up screen, drag and drop the approval letter into the field, or click “browse files” to find the correct one. Upon uploading, scroll to the bottom, click “Save”, and close out of the pop-up screen. To see your changes, click the “Save Draft” button on the application.

Please make sure to use the project proposal template provided for this funding opportunity.	If you are using the incorrect version of the MJFF project proposal template, the system will prevent you from submitting your application.	To ensure you are using the correct template, download the file that's located in the "Documents" field at the top of the application, under "Print Preview". Once you have used the correct template, the system will permit you to submit your application.
Other Funding Sources cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This field can be found in the Project Proposal Template tab. Please fill out this information in the provided field.
Full Proposal Confirmation cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This can be found in the "Project Proposal Template" tab. Please read and acknowledge the statement by checking the box.

Full Proposal Confirmation Signature cannot be empty. Please type the full name of the Principal Investigator for confirmation. This should be the main applicant and the same person listed in the Principal Investigator role in the Research Team Members grid.	This is a required field that must be filled in prior to submission.	This can be found in the “Project Proposal Template” tab. Please confirm your submission of your application by typing in your full name as it appears on your account.
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Administrative Requirements Revisions Submission Errors and Solutions

ERROR	REASON FOR ERROR	SOLUTION FOR ERROR
Please attach a Lay Abstract.	This is a required item that must be completed in order to move your project forward in the contracting process.	This field can be found in the Attachments tab of the application. Please use the abstract provided by clicking the “Download Lay Abstract Template” button. Drag and drop the file into the field. Note that the document must be a .doc or .docx file. After uploading, press the “Save My Work” button to record these changes. Please note that this lay abstract will be shared on the MJFF website together with your project title and PI and Co-PI biographies.

Initial for Confirmation of No Other Funding Sources cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be completed in order to move your project forward in the contracting process.	This can be found in the Project Proposal Template section in the application. Enter your initials and press the “Save My Work” button to record this change.
Confirmation of No Other Funding Sources cannot be empty.	This is a required field that must be completed in order to move your project forward in the contracting process.	This can be found in the Project Proposal Template section in the application. Please check the box to confirm and press the “Save My Work” button to record this change.
Please attach a Researcher Bio.	This is a required field that must be completed in order to move your project forward in the contracting process.	This field can be found in the Attachments tab of the application. Please use the researcher bio template provided by clicking the “Download Research Bio Template” button. Once you have completed the document, drag and drop the file into the field. Only one Researcher Bio template should be uploaded (PIs and Co-PIs should collate their bios into one document prior to submission). Note that the document must be a .doc or .docx file. After uploading, press the “Save My Work” button to record this change. Please note that these biographies will be shared on the MJFF website together with your project title and lay abstract.

Please make sure you upload a W8 /W9 for each collaborating institution.	This is a required field that must be completed in order to move your project forward in the contracting process and to ensure your payments are received in a timely manner.	This can be found in the attachments tab. For each collaborating institution listed in the application, a bank letter and a W8 or W9 must be uploaded. To upload the documents, in the Collaborating Institution Attachments table, click the “Upload Documents” table for the organization that needs the documents. In the pop-up that appears, either drop the files into the respective fields, or click the “browse files” link to search for the file needed. Once the documents have been uploaded, scroll to the bottom of the pop up and click the “Save” button to save your work. Then close out of the pop-up screen and click the “Save Draft” button on the application to see your changes reflected in the table.
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